

OPENJUSTICE

USER GUIDE

A No-Code Platform for Legal Reasoning

Version 3.0

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Introduction

OpenJustice is a no-code platform for enabling frontier models to perform legal reasoning. This document provides an overview of the functionality of different features within OpenJustice (version 2).

Definitions

Term	Definition
Reasoning Flow	A structured AI workflow, often resembling a sideways decision tree, that guides an AI agent through the step-by-step analysis of a legal issue.
Nodes	The fundamental building blocks of a reasoning flow. Each node represents a specific step, action, or piece of logic in the workflow.
Edges	The visual lines in the builder interface that connect nodes, showing how the workflow moves from one step to the next.
Connector	A circular point on a node where edges attach. Users can click and drag from a connector to create a connection between nodes.
Node Panel	A panel on the right side of the interface that appears when a node is selected. It contains the settings and configuration options for that node.

Builder UI



Figure 1: Builder UI toolbar

At the top of the Builder UI, the functionality of each button (from left to right) is as follows:

#	Object Name	Description
1	Left Arrow	Returns to the dashboard interface.
2	Reasoning Selector Flow	Switch between different reasoning flows.
3	Edit/Test Toggle Mode	Switch between editing and executing the reasoning flow.
4	Timestamp	Indicates the last time the reasoning flow was automatically saved.
5	Manual Save	Manually saves the reasoning flow without having to wait for auto-save to trigger.
6	Undo/Redo	Undo's or redo's the previous change correspondingly.
7	AI Builder	Opens up a side panel that allows you to design and build a dialog flow by chatting with our AI builder agent. Note feature is still in beta.
8	Magic Wand	Re-aligns the visual layout of the nodes.
9	Three Dot Menu	Dropdown menu displaying options to: (a) Edit: Rename the reasoning flow (b) Fork: Make a copy of the reasoning flow (c) Delete: Delete the reasoning flow
10	Private/Public Badge	Make the reasoning flow public or private for other users to access.

Nodes

We instill legal knowledge through the use of reasoning flows, which are specified by nodes connected by edges. The five types of nodes are:

1. Start Node
2. Fact Node
3. Reasoning Node
4. Switch Node
5. Outcome Node

Start Node

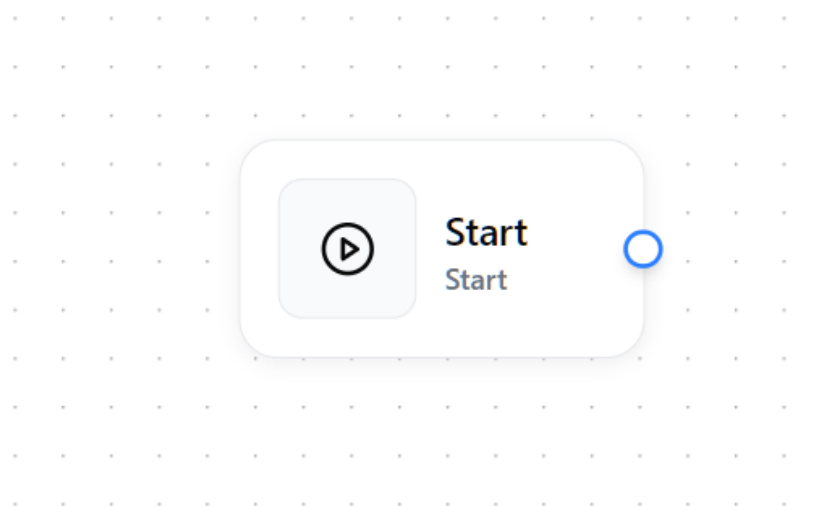


Figure 2: Start Node

Purpose: A visual anchor to indicate the start of the reasoning flow. When the reasoning flow is added to a conversation, OpenJustice starts executing prompts from this point. There is nothing to configure or add to this node.

Fact Node

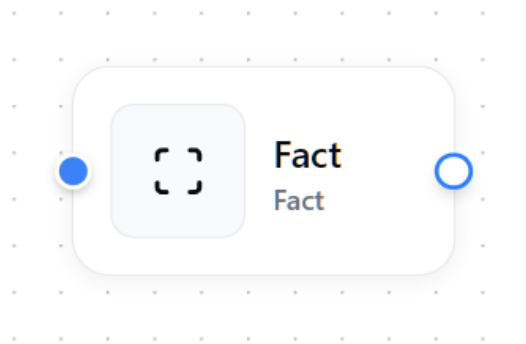


Figure 3: Fact Node

Purpose: The Fact Node collects, analyzes and stores key information from the users for use in subsequent steps in the reasoning flow sequence. This node will allow builders to outline the material facts required for subsequent nodes in the process.

Builders can configure the Fact Node to:

1. Ask questions – such as details on the user’s employment history, job title, jurisdiction of residence, and other material facts.
2. Request documents – such as contracts, client correspondences, and other relevant files for analysis.

Please note the current functionality is meant for simple facts, like those that could be found on an intake form, rather than a complex fact pattern that might be found in a court opinion.

What the Fact Node Returns

Fact Item	Output	Description
Fact 1	Response	The ai generated response for your legal question returned in the specified data response format
	Rationale	A detailed legal analysis supporting the response
	Sources	The exact citations used in generating the Rationale

Fact Node Panel

The screenshot shows the 'Fact Node configuration panel' for a node named 'Sky Colour'. The panel has a title bar with a close button and a help icon. Below the title, it says 'Collects structured facts from responses.' The main configuration area is divided into two sections. The top section is for the overall node configuration, and the bottom section is for a specific fact configuration (labeled 'FACT 1').

Numbered callouts (1-6) highlight the following elements:

- 1.** The 'Name' input field, which contains 'Sky Colour'.
- 2.** The 'Fact Name' input field, which contains 'Sky Colour'.
- 3.** The 'Instructions' text area, which contains 'What colour is the sky?'.
- 4.** The 'Mandatory Field' toggle switch, which is currently turned off.
- 5.** The 'Response Type' dropdown menu, which is currently set to 'Text'.
- 6.** The '+ Add Fact' button at the bottom of the panel.

Figure 4: Fact Node configuration panel

Builders can configure their Fact Node using the Node Panel that pops up after clicking on the specified Fact Node. As a default, only one fact is requested at a time. Builders requesting for more than one fact should use the Add Fact button (see below). The functions of the Node Panel are described below:

#	Object Name	Description
1	Name	Allow builders to create a label for the selected Fact Node. Note: this label does not affect the AI's behaviour.
2	Fact Name	Allow builders to create a label to describe the fact. Note: this label does not affect the AI's behaviour.

3	Instructions	Textbox for inputting prompting instructions to the AI. Builders can provide detailed instructions (i.e. questions) for the AI to prompt users to provide specific information or documents. Toggle switch to require users to answer the question:
4	Mandatory Field	6. If this is toggled on and the user does not provide the required information, the AI will prompt the user to provide the information in the specified format until it receives it. 7. If this is toggled off and the user does not provide the required information, the AI will prompt the user in the specified format once before moving on.
5	Response Type	Allow users to specify the format the Fact should take from one of the following options: 1) Text – short, free-form text (no longer than a sentence) 2) Percentage – a percentage value 3) Confidence – a likelihood of a certain event, with possible values: Impossible, Highly Unlikely, Unlikely, Even Chance, Likely, Highly Likely, Almost Certain, and Proven. 4) Number – a whole or decimal number 5) Date 6) True/False 7) Custom – When this is selected there is a new menu to add custom values and the AI will choose from one of those options. If the AI is uncertain which option to choose, it will default to null.
6	+ Add Fact	Add an additional fact to provide.

Reasoning Node

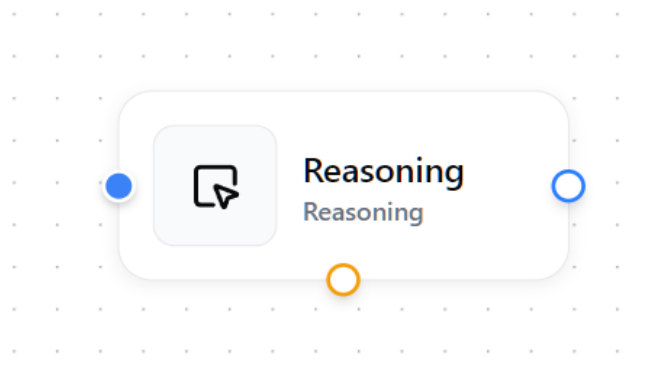


Figure 6: Reasoning Node

Purpose: The main engine of the workflow, the reasoning node synthesizes an answer to a specific question by applying a multi-step agentic process that analyzes and answers questions in a legal professional context. It is recommended to name/group reasoning nodes by the overarching legal issue they address.

What the Reasoning Node Returns

Output	Description
Response	The AI generated response for your legal question returned in the specified data response format
Rationale	A detailed legal analysis explaining the logic for how the AI generated it's answer.
Sources	The exact citations used in generating the Rationale
Relevant Documents	Legal Returns any cited or relevant law sources retrieved from our law document database if configured.

Child Reasoning Nodes

Use Child Reasoning Nodes to break a complex legal question into smaller, manageable sub-questions.

How It Works:

1. Child nodes are answered first, from the bottom up
2. Parent nodes receive and incorporate their children's answers

3. The root (top-level) Reasoning Node is answered last, drawing on all the analysis below it

Building Tip: Ask yourself: *What sub-issues must be resolved to answer the main question?*

Example: To assess whether there was a substantial breach of employment terms, you might create child nodes for:

- What are the terms of employment?
- How were those terms breached?

Each child node feeds its answer into the parent, building toward a comprehensive final response.

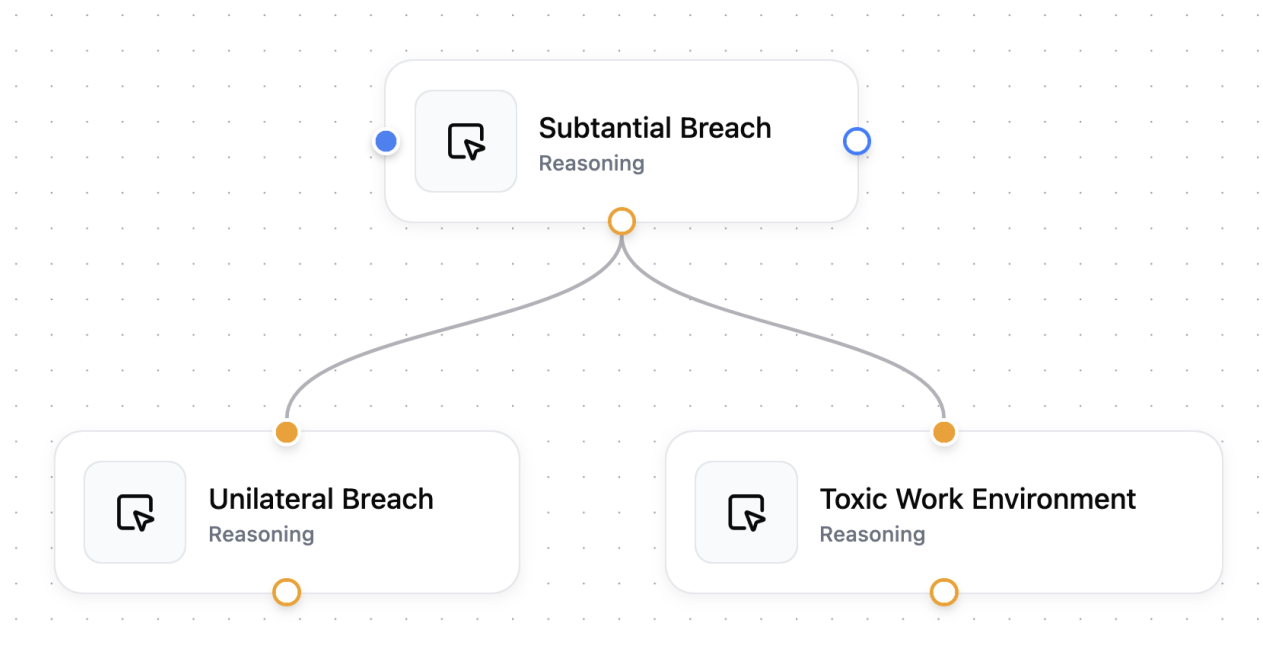


Figure 7: Child Reasoning Nodes hierarchy

Reasoning Node Configuration

Constructive Dismissal

...

i

x

Analyzes a complex legal question.

Name i

1. Constructive Dismissal

Question i

The reasoning node's question is the main complex legal question we're trying to answer.

2. Was there constructive dismissal?

Instructions i

The instructions are used to provide guidance and analytic breakdowns of how to answer the legal question.

3. LEGAL FRAMEWORK

Constructive dismissal occurs when an employer unilaterally makes a substantial change to an essential term of the employment contract, such that the employee is effectively forced to resign. The leading authority is Farber v. Royal Trust Co. [1997] 1 SCR 846 (Supreme Court of Canada).

A constructive dismissal can arise in two ways:

1. A single unilateral change so substantial it breaches a fundamental term of the contract

4. Response Type i

☒ True/False ▾

Figure 8: Reasoning Node configuration panel

The Reasoning Node contains the following components:

#	Object Name	Description
1	Name	Allow builders to create a label for the selected Reasoning Node. Note: this label does not affect the AI's behaviour, but it is used as a the identifier for referencing the reasoning node in the switch node.
2	Question	The overall question guiding the Reasoning Node's final response.
3	Instructions	A detailed guide on how to answer the question. Clicking on the text box opens a more detailed text editor that allows text formatting and adding Footnotes (described below).
4	Response Type	Similar to the Fact Node, the Response can be returned in a specific format specified by this field.

When you click on System Instructions text box a text editor page will appear where you can write very detailed instructions outlining your detailed steps for assessing a question.

Adding Footnotes

In the example below, we included instructions on how to determine some legal tests for a constructive dismissal case:

The screenshot displays the 'Instructions' text editor interface. At the top, there's a title 'Instructions' with a close button. Below it, a subtitle reads: 'Guide the model on how to answer this node's question—what to cover, how to reason, and any constraints. Use footnotes to reference documents or citations in your instructions.' The main text area contains legal text about constructive dismissal, including a definition, a list of ways it can arise, and criteria to examine. A red box highlights the 'Add Footnote' button in the top right of the text editor. On the right side, there's a 'Footnotes (1)' sidebar showing a single footnote: '[1] "Constructive dismissal o...'. The footer has 'Cancel' and 'Done' buttons.

Instructions ×

Guide the model on how to answer this node's question—what to cover, how to reason, and any constraints. Use footnotes to reference documents or citations in your instructions.

LEGAL FRAMEWORK

Constructive dismissal occurs when an employer unilaterally makes a substantial change to an essential term of the employment contract, such that the employee is effectively forced to resign. The leading authority is *Farber v. Royal Trust Co.* [1997] 1 SCR 846 (Supreme Court of Canada).^[1]

A constructive dismissal can arise in two ways:

1. A single unilateral change so substantial it breaches a fundamental term of the contract
2. A series of acts that together show the employer no longer intends to be bound by the contract (poisoned work environment)

CRITERIA TO EXAMINE

Assess the facts against these common categories:

- **WAGE/COMPENSATION CUT:** Was there a reduction in base salary, commission structure, or benefits without consent? A cut of 10% or more is generally considered substantial.
- **DEMOTION:** Was the employee moved to a lesser role, title, or reduced responsibilities without agreement?
- **RELOCATION:** Was the employee forced to move to a new location that was not contemplated in their contract?
- **HOSTILE WORK ENVIRONMENT:** Was there a pattern of harassment, humiliation, or marginalization by management?
- **ROLE CHANGE:** Were fundamental duties stripped away or dramatically altered?

CONDONATION RISK

Assess whether the employee may have condoned the change by:

- Continuing to work

Footnotes (1) ×

[1] "Constructive dismissal o... 📄

Principal authority: 2015 SCC 10 (CanLII) – Potter v. New Brunswick Legal Aid Services Commission _ CanLII.pdf

Cancel Done

Figure 9: System Instructions text editor with footnote capability

Purpose: To provide the Reasoning Node with specific documents to look at to support its analysis. To add a citation, highlight portions of the System Instructions and then click **"Add Citation"**.

It will open a new Citation UI, shown below:

The screenshot shows a 'Footnote Reference' dialog box. On the left, a text area contains the following text: 'Constructive dismissal occurs when an employer unilaterally makes a substantial change to an essential term of the employment contract, such that the employee is effectively forced to resign. The leading authority is Farber v. Royal Trust Co. [1997] 1 SCR 846 (Supreme Court of Canada).' To the right of this text is a search bar labeled 'Search citations...'. Below the search bar is a table with columns: 'Name', 'Type', and 'Citation use'. One entry is visible: '2015 SCC 10 (CanLII) _ Potter v. New Brunswi...' with a 'File' type and 'Principal authority' citation use. At the bottom right of the dialog are 'Cancel' and 'Done' buttons. A status bar at the bottom indicates 'Principal: 1 · Illustrative: 0'.

Name	Type	Citation use
2015 SCC 10 (CanLII) _ Potter v. New Brunswi...	File	Principal authority

Figure 10: Citation user interface

Citations

OpenJustice supports two types of citations to ground and refine the AI's legal analysis:

Principal Authority: The direct source of highlighted text in your System Instructions that:

- Establishes where the highlighted passage originates
- Anchors the Document Search to relevant authorities
- Enables OpenJustice to ground its analysis in the Sources section of the output
- **Example:** *To analyze the enforceability of termination provisions, you might upload a Primary Citation containing the relevant paragraphs from Waksdale v. Swegon North America Inc., 2020 ONCA 391. This case established a key principle: an invalid just cause termination clause can render an otherwise valid without cause termination clause unenforceable. By citing the specific paragraphs that articulate this principle, you anchor the AI's analysis to the foundational law on this issue.*

Illustrative Authority: Additional examples showing how the highlighted System Instruction text appears across legal sources that:

- Provides supporting context for the primary citation
- Helps narrow the scope of relevant legal sources used to answer the question
- **Example:** *To provide additional context for the principles established in Waksdale, you may also add additional cases that referenced the original citation to provide details on how the case has been subsequently applied. In this case, we've included the case Rahman v. Cannon Design Architecture Inc., 2022 ONCA 451, where the court affirmed the Waksdale decision.*

Citation Source Options

Each citation can be a file from the file library or it can be a manually typed snippet of text Figure 11. Uploaded files will automatically be stored in the file library for future reference.

- Paste Text – Paste snippets of relevant text to be used as citation references
- Upload File – Uploads a file into the file library and adds it to the list of citations
- From Library – Allows you to select files or pasted text snippets from the media library

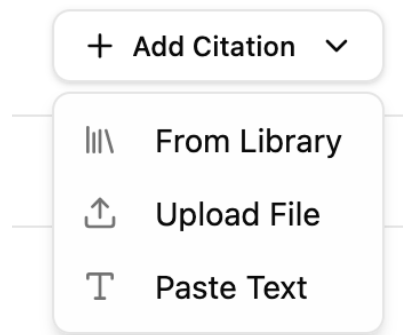


Figure 11: Add Citation Source Options

Paste Text Citation

Create a new citation by pasting text content.

Title *

e.g., Employment Act Excerpt...

Content *

Paste your source text here...

Source details (optional) ▾

Source Title

e.g., Article title...

Source URL

https://...

Source Date

e.g., 2024...

Add as:

☒ Primary Source

☐ Supplemental Source

Cancel

Add Citation

Figure 12: Paste Text UI

Add from Library

×

Select citations to add and choose their role. (145272 available)

Q

Search citations...

Type: **All** Files T Text

Visibility: **All** Public Private

☐	Name	Visibility	Type
☐	Cour de Cassation, Chambre commerciale,...0.949, Publiè au bulletin - Leigifra... Cour de Cassation, Chambre commerciale, du 26 novembre 2003, 00-10.243 00- 10.949, Pu...	Private	File
☐	Cour de Cassation, Chambre commerciale,...4.154, Publiè au bulletin - Leigifra... Cour de Cassation, Chambre commerciale, du 20 mars 1972, 70-14.154, Publiè au bulletin Co...	Private	File
☐	Article 1231-1 - Code civil - Leigifrance.pdf Code civil Article 1231-1 Version en vigueur depuis le 01 octobre 2016 Création Ordonnance ...	Private	File
☐	Article 1112 - Code civil - Leigifrance.pdf Code civil Article 1112 Version en vigueur depuis le 01 octobre 2018 Modifié par LOI n°2018-...	Private	File
☐	Article 1112 - Code civil - Leigifrance.pdf Code civil Article 1112 Version en vigueur depuis le 01 octobre 2018 Modifié par LOI n°2018-...	Private	File

Add as:

☒ Primary Source
 ☐ Supplemental Source

Cancel

Add Selected (0)

Figure 13: Add From Library UI

Document Search Configuration

Purpose: For each footnote, OpenJustice can automatically supplement your uploaded materials by searching for related authorities in the OpenJustice database.

How it works: The feature uses RAG to surface relevant cases and legal materials for the user's scenario, which the Reasoning Node will use to cite in its explanation. Use the checkboxes to restrict document types that may be returned or referenced. All enabled filters apply together (AND): each selected constraint must match for a document to qualify.

Configure Citation Sources ✕

Select primary sources, supplemental materials, and configure document search for this citation.

Even if they fall within the scope of civil and commercial matters, certain categories are excluded from the application of the Brussels I bis Regulation. In deed, according to article 1§2 of the Brussels I bis Regulation : "This Regulation shall not apply to: (a) the status or legal capacity of natural persons, rights in property arising out of a matrimonial relationship or out of a relationship deemed by the law applicable to such relationship to have comparable effects to marriage; (b) bankruptcy, proceedings relating to the winding-up of insolvent companies or other legal persons, judicial arrangements, compositions and analogous proceedings; (c) social security; (d) arbitration; (e) maintenance obligations arising from a family relationship, parentage, marriage or affinity; (f) wills and succession, including maintenance obligations arising by reason of death.

Search citations...

+ Add Citation ▾

Document Search On (1)

☐ Name

Enable Document Search ☑

Search for relevant documents based on the highlighted text

Active Filters (1)

Ontario ✕

Geographic Jurisdiction

☒ Ontario ☐ British Columbia

☐ Quebec ☐ Alberta

☐ Saskatchewan ☐ Manitoba

☐ Nova Scotia ☐ New Brunswick

Subject Matter

☐ Employment Law ☐ Corporate Law

☐ Contract Law ☐ Tort Law

☐ Criminal Law ☐ Family Law

Cancel Done

Figure 15: Document Search configuration with filters

Switch Node

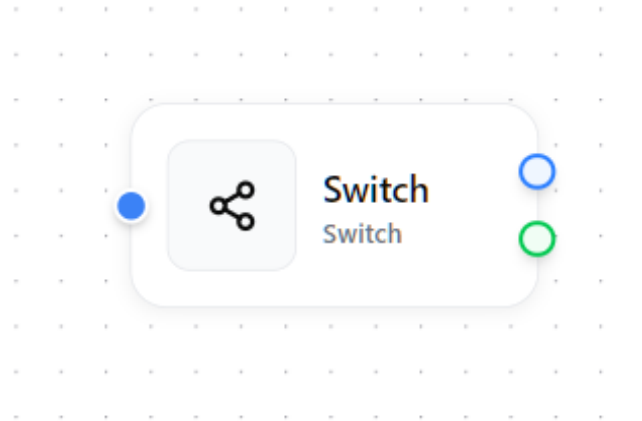


Figure 16: Switch Node

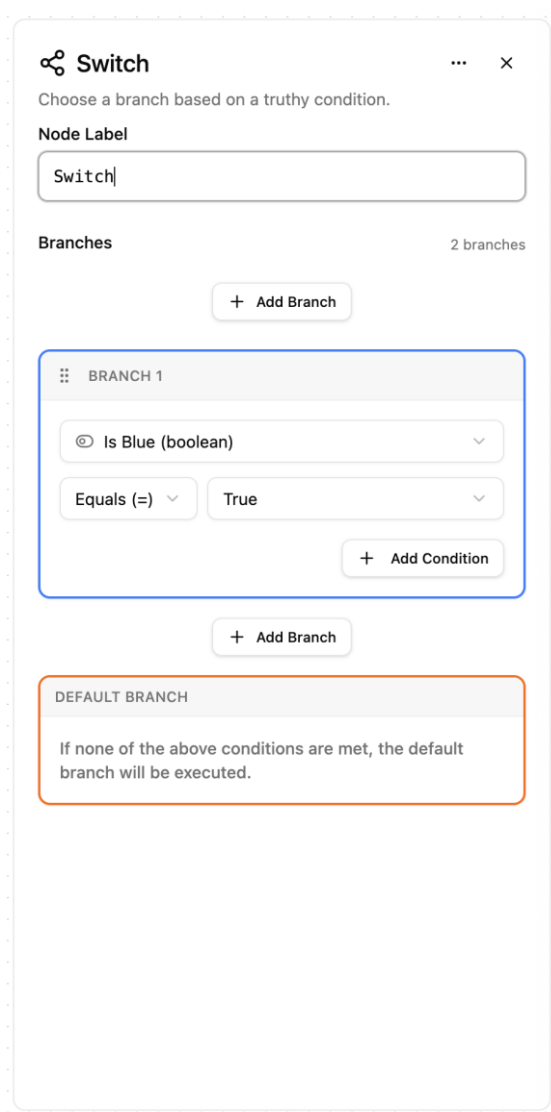
Purpose: To guide OpenJustice down a specific path (AKA branch) depending on conditions of the user's case. The Switch node can reference the Responses from both Fact Nodes and Reasoning Nodes.

What the Switch Node Returns

Output	Description
Condition	The evaluated condition for that branch
Operator	The operator we used to evaluate the condition and the operand with
Operand	The value we're comparing against
Result	The true or false answer that the branch evaluated to

Switch Node Configuration

The switch node can specify one (or more) branches. Add more branches with the "+ Add Branch" button.



Switch ... X

Choose a branch based on a truthy condition.

Node Label

Switch|

Branches 2 branches

+ Add Branch

BRANCH 1

Is Blue (boolean) ▾

Equals (=) ▾ True ▾

+ Add Condition

+ Add Branch

DEFAULT BRANCH

If none of the above conditions are met, the default branch will be executed.

Figure 17: Switch Node configuration panel

Branches are used to set "truthy conditions" – that is, if the specified Response meets the conditions, the reasoning flow will continue with that branch. It is possible to use logical conventions to join statements.

Example 1: To isolate clients that were employed 1-3 years, the branch can be set like this (notice the AND option was selected from the dropdown):

The screenshot shows a configuration window titled "BRANCH 1". It contains two conditions connected by an "AND" operator. The first condition is "# Years of Employment (number)" with a value of "Greater Than or Equal ($\geq$)" and "1". The second condition is "# Years of Employment (number)" with a value of "Less Than (<)" and "3". There is an "Add Condition" button at the bottom right.

Figure 18: Branch configuration with AND logic

Example 2: To isolate clients from either Ontario or British Columbia (notice the OR option is selected from the dropdown):

The screenshot shows a configuration window titled "BRANCH 1". It contains two conditions connected by an "OR" operator. The first condition is "T Jurisdiction (custom)" with a value of "Equals (=)" and "Ontario". The second condition is "T Jurisdiction (custom)" with a value of "Equals (=)" and "British Columbia". There is an "Add Condition" button at the bottom right and an "Add Branch" button at the bottom center.

Figure 19: Branch configuration with OR logic

All branches are colour coded to the builder UI. Once a branch is set, use edges in the main builder UI to link the Switch node's branch to the next step of the reasoning flow.

Outcome Node

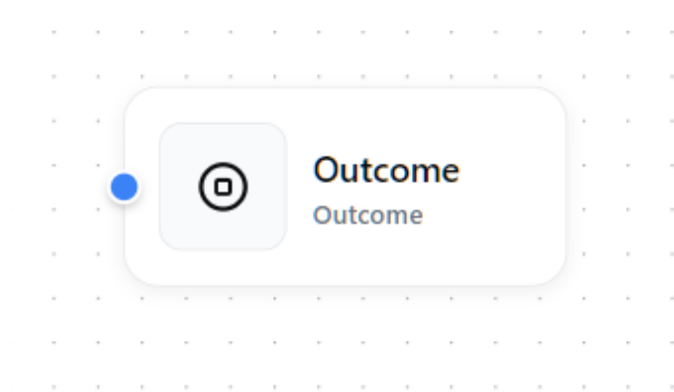


Figure 20: Outcome Node

Purpose: To generate a final legal conclusion based on the analysis done through the entire dialogue flow. There is an option to add system instructions and Criteria, which provides further guidelines for the Output Node to follow during its final evaluation.

Outcome Node Panel

Legal Opinion ... ⓘ ✕

Final outcome response for the dialog flow analysis.

Name ⓘ

1. Legal Opinion

Instructions ⓘ

Overall guidance for the model across the whole outcome—not the per-section tasks in the template below.

2. Using the following layout use the facts gathered to format the answer.

Response template ⓘ

Plain text appears as-is in the answer; {{ ... }} blocks are instructions and are replaced by generated content.

Static text — appears verbatim in the answer
 {{ ... }} — model generates from the inner instructions

3. **Summary**

{{Provide a legal summary that outlines the key points just as a bullet list and nothing else}}

Facts

{{ Provide a list of the facts collected about the client's situation, but make sure to bold and underline key facts that are essential for the analysis }}

Figure 21: Outcome Node configuration panel

The following fields can be configured in the outcome node. However, the **Response Template** field is optional as it allows for a more deterministic AI response.

#	Object Name	Description
1	Name	Allow builders to create a label for the selected Outcome Node. Note: this label does not affect the AI's behaviour.
2	Instructions	The overall question guiding the outcome node on how to generate its answer

3	Response Template (Optional)	An layout template for how the AI should structure its output. If the response template is used, the exact output of the LLM will match the content in the text editor. However, instructions/text written in <code>{{ }}</code> will be interpreted as instructions for the AI to evaluate and generate a dynamic response from it.
---	-------------------------------------	--

Example 1 (No Response Template): When a user doesn't need the output to follow a specific format, they can simply fill in the **'Instructions'** field and leave the **'Response Template'** empty — allowing the AI to generate a free-form answer, as shown below.

Legal Opinion ... ⓘ ×

Final outcome response for the dialog flow analysis.

Name ⓘ

Legal Opinion

Instructions ⓘ

Overall guidance for the model across the whole outcome—not the per-section tasks in the template below.

Provide a legal opinion on the matter.

Response template ⓘ

Plain text appears as-is in the answer; `{{ ... }}` blocks are instructions and are replaced by generated content.

Static text — appears verbatim in the answer
`{{ ... }}` — model generates from the inner instructions

Mix fixed text with generation blocks.

Summary

{{Bullet list of key points only}}

Facts

{{List gathered facts; bold and underline what matters most}}

LEGAL OPINION Outcome

- > Extract Requirements 3 requirements extracted 2.9s
- > Analyze: Analyze the relevant legal issues 2 sources used 11.3s
- > Analyze: Assess the facts against the law 2 sources used 6.9s
- > Analyze: State the legal opinion and conclusion 2 sources used 8.5s
- > Generate Final Outcome 8.8s

In your situation, you have a compelling case regarding the salary reduction imposed by your employer. Here is a detailed legal opinion based on the facts presented and relevant legal principles.

Legal Analysis

- Breach of Contract:** Your employer's unilateral decision to cut your salary by 15% without any prior notice or discussion constitutes a fundamental breach of your employment contract. According to *Farber v. Royal Trust Co.*, significant changes to employment terms, such as salary reductions, require mutual consent. The abrupt nature of this pay cut suggests a significant alteration that you did not agree to, indicating a potential breach of contract.
- Notifying the Employer:** Your prompt written objection to the pay cut highlights your rejection of the new terms. This aligns with the principles established in *Hilton v. Norampac Inc.*, reinforcing your legal position by clearly indicating that you did not accept the change. Documenting your disagreement is vital in substantiating your claims.
- Causation for Resignation:** Your resignation linked directly to the pay cut illustrates a clear causal relationship. By explicitly stating in your resignation letter that the pay reduction was the reason for leaving, you provide strong evidence that the employer's actions left you no choice but to resign.
- Timing of Resignation:** Remaining in your role for approximately three weeks post-notification shows your attempt to resolve the issue. This timeline reflects good faith and can be significant when evaluating the reasonableness of your response to the breach.

Conclusion

Based on the nature of the salary cut, your immediate objections, and your resignation letter clearly stating the reason for your departure, you have a solid basis for arguing constructive dismissal. The employer's actions likely amount to a fundamental breach of your employment agreement, giving you grounds to pursue compensation or damages.

It is recommended that you consult a legal professional specializing in employment law to explore your options further, such as filing a formal claim for wrongful dismissal or negotiating a settlement. This approach will help ensure your rights are protected and that you receive appropriate compensation for the changes imposed upon your employment.

Sources: *Farber v. Royal Trust Co.*, [1997] 1 SCR 846; *Hilton v. Norampac Inc.*, [2003] O.J. No. 1786.

Example 2 (With Response Template): When a user needs the output to follow a specific layout — with dynamic content appearing only in designated sections — they should use the **'Response Template'** to enforce a structured AI output. Any sections wrapped in double curly bracket tags `'{{ ... }}'` will be treated as inline instructions for the AI to complete, while all remaining text in the editor will appear exactly as written. The **'Instructions'** field, when paired with the **'Response Template'**, acts as a set of general guidelines that all inline instructions within the template will follow.

Legal Opinion

Final outcome response for the dialog flow analysis.

Name

Legal Opinion

Instructions

Overall guidance for the model across the whole outcome—not the per-section tasks in the template below.

Answer the following questions using the previously collected facts.

Response template

Plain text appears as-is in the answer; {{ ... }} blocks are instructions and are replaced by generated content.

Static text — appears verbatim in the answer

{{ ... }} — model generates from the inner instructions

Summary

{{ Give me a short TLDR about the case }}

Facts

{{ Provide me a bullet point list of facts about the case }}

Conclusion

LEGAL OPINION

Outcome

Summary

The case involves an employee who experienced an unexpected 15% salary reduction without prior discussion, which they viewed as a fundamental breach of their employment agreement. After formally objecting to the pay cut in writing and receiving confirmation from HR that there would be no recourse, the employee resigned, explicitly citing the pay cut as the reason for their departure. This raises potential claims surrounding breach of contract and constructive dismissal.

Facts

- Employer cut the employee's salary by 15% without prior warning or discussion.
- Employee discovered the reduction upon noticing a short deposit.
- The employee formally objected in writing to their manager about the pay cut.
- HR responded that the pay cut was final and there was nothing to discuss.
- Employee continued to work for three weeks following the pay cut while assessing their options.
- Upon resignation, the employee explicitly cited the pay cut as the direct reason for leaving.
- The employee regarded the pay cut as a fundamental breach of their employment agreement.

Conclusion

The final consensus is that the employee has a potentially strong case for constructive dismissal based on the sudden and unilateral salary reduction. The employer's failure to provide prior notice or engage in any discussion regarding the pay cut constitutes a fundamental breach of the employment agreement, as it significantly alters the terms of employment without consent. The employee's timely written objection and subsequent resignation connected to this breach further supports their claim. Given the legal precedent set in cases like *Farber v. Royal Trust Co.*, which recognizes similar circumstances, the employee could pursue a legal challenge for constructive dismissal, seeking compensation for lost wages and potential damages. However, the specific outcomes would depend on the jurisdiction and the particulars of the employment contract.

Helpful Tips and Resources

Throughout the builder interface, you will see information icons like the one shown below. Hovering your cursor over these icons will display additional details and context about the feature. In addition, the information icon located in the top-right corner of each node panel provides a more detailed pop-up explaining how to use that node.

Constructive Dismissal ... ⓘ ← ×

Analyzes a complex legal question.

Name ⓘ ←

Constructive Dismissal

Question ⓘ ←

The reasoning node's question is the main complex legal question we're trying to answer.

Was there constructive dismissal?

Instructions ⓘ ←

The instructions are used to provide guidance and analytic breakdowns of how to answer the legal question.

LEGAL FRAMEWORK

Constructive dismissal occurs when an employer unilaterally makes a substantial change to an essential term of the employment contract, such that the employee is effectively forced to resign. The leading authority is *Farber v. Royal Trust Co.* [1997] 1 SCR 846 (Supreme Court of Canada).

A constructive dismissal can arise in two ways:

Specifies the format the LLM should use when responding to this fact. Choose Text for open-ended answers, True/False for yes/no questions, Date for date inputs, or other formats as needed.

Response Type ⓘ ←

True/False ▾

Assembling a Reasoning Flow

The reasoning flow begins from the Start Node and progresses from node to node as indicated by edges. Generally, edges flow left → right (or top → bottom for Child Reasoning Nodes), further indicated visually in builder UI – the solid connector (a solid fill colour with a white outline) is the end point of an edge, while the empty connector (white fill colour with a solid outline) is the starting point.

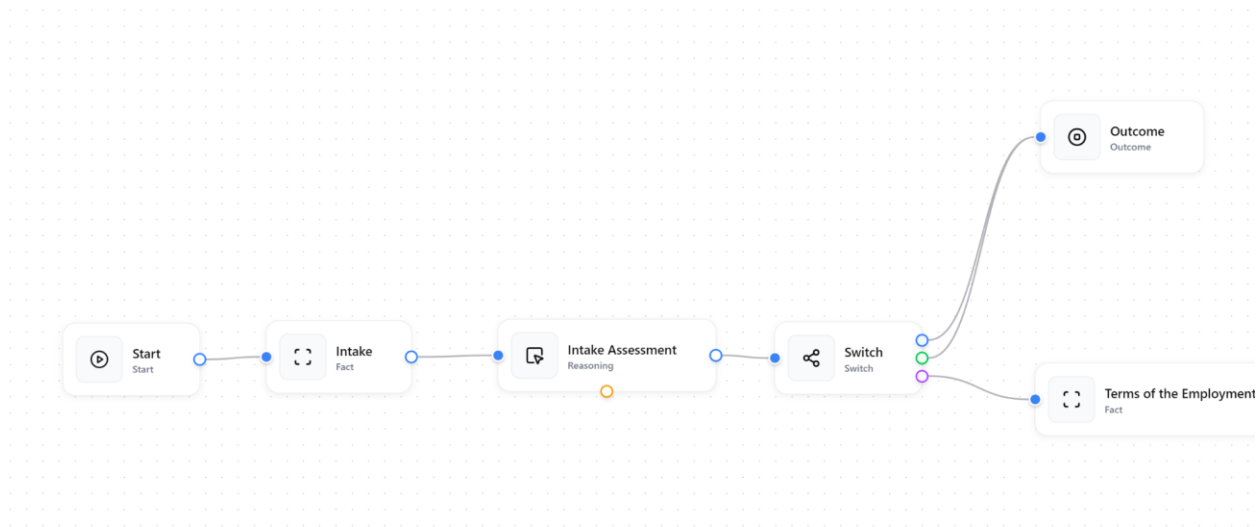


Figure 22: Example of a complete reasoning flow with connectors